

D549

Exploring Emerging Trends in Healthcare Administration

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A health system gives each of its clinics the same \$50,000 outreach budget. Clinic A serves a suburb with high insurance coverage; Clinic B serves a neighborhood where 40% of residents lack a car and many are uninsured. The system's new logo appears on all outreach materials. A board member calls the plan fair. Which statement best describes it?

- A. It is equitable, because every clinic gets the same amount.
- B. It is equal but not equitable; equity would size outreach to need, giving Clinic B more.
- C. It is inequitable because Clinic A should get more, since it serves more insured patients.
- D. Equity would require both clinics to reach exactly the same outcomes within one year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which action is an example of equity rather than equality?

- A. Giving every patient the same 15-minute appointment length.
- B. Giving every patient the same portal login instructions by email.
- C. Guaranteeing that every patient has identical health outcomes.
- D. Providing free ride vouchers to patients who live in areas with no public transit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A hospital with a top-rated cardiac unit sees high heart-failure readmissions among patients from one ZIP code. Chart review shows many lack refrigeration for their medications and live far from grocery stores. The hospital's cardiologists trained at leading programs. Which step best addresses the root cause?

- A. Hire more cardiologists for the cardiac unit.
- B. Send the cardiologists to advanced training.
- C. Label these patients noncompliant and flag them in the chart.
- D. Screen for social needs and partner with community groups on food access and medication storage.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A Spanish-speaking patient arrives for a consent discussion before surgery. Her bilingual adult son, who works as a paralegal, offers to interpret. The clinic has phone access to qualified medical interpreters. The clinic was recently named a best place to work. What should staff do?

- A. Use a qualified medical interpreter; the son may stay for support but should not interpret.
- B. Proceed in English and have her sign, since the form is in English.
- C. Let the son interpret, since he is fluent and the patient trusts him.
- D. Let the son interpret, since his legal work covers consent forms.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An administrator hears at a conference that AI scribes will cut physician documentation time in half. The vendor's booth was the largest at the event, and three nearby systems have signed contracts. What is the best next step?

- A. Run a limited pilot with clear measures such as documentation time, accuracy, clinician satisfaction and privacy before scaling.
- B. Sign a system-wide contract now so the system is not left behind by its neighbors.
- C. Reject AI scribes, because new technology always fails to meet the hype.
- D. Wait until every hospital in the country has adopted it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A health system moves most follow-up visits to video to cut no-shows. Afterward, follow-up completion rises overall but falls among patients over 75 and rural patients with poor broadband. The telehealth platform won a design award. What is the best response?

- A. Keep video but add phone and in-person options and help with devices and connectivity for the affected groups.
- B. End telehealth entirely.
- C. Redesign the app's screens to make them easier to use.
- D. Declare success, since overall completion rose.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Under a new contract, a primary care group receives a fixed monthly payment per enrolled member and shares in savings if total cost of care falls while quality targets are met. The group's building recently added solar panels. Which behavior does this model reward most?

- A. Refusing all specialist referrals to cut cost.
- B. Keeping members healthy and avoiding unnecessary ER visits and admissions.
- C. Scheduling more visits and procedures.
- D. Coding every visit as completely as possible.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which payment model gives a provider the most revenue for performing more tests and procedures, whether or not outcomes improve?

- A. Pay-for-performance.
- B. Capitation.
- C. Fee-for-service.
- D. Bundled payment.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A retail pharmacy chain opens walk-in clinics staffed by nurse practitioners that treat simple conditions like strep throat at a low posted price. The chain's stores run loyalty programs with millions of members. Hospitals dismissed the clinics as too basic. According to disruptive innovation theory, what makes this model disruptive?

- A. It targets hospitals' most complex, most profitable patients.
- B. It uses more advanced technology than hospitals.
- C. Its large loyalty program.
- D. It offers simpler, cheaper, more convenient care for low-end needs and can move upmarket over time.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hospital adds a robotic system that makes its complex surgeries somewhat more precise for its existing, well-insured patients. What type of innovation is this?

- A.** A revenue-cycle process innovation.
- B.** Disruptive, because all new technology is disruptive.
- C.** Sustaining innovation.
- D.** Disruptive innovation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A health system stratifies its maternal outcomes. Among 2,000 Black mothers, 36 had severe maternal morbidity; among 5,000 white mothers, 40 did. The analysis was run in the system's new data warehouse. What is the rate ratio for Black vs. white mothers?

- A.** 1.0 percentage point
- B.** 0.9
- C.** 2.25
- D.** 0.44

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Group A's rate of missed cancer screenings is 12%. The rate ratio of Group A to Group B is 1.5. What is Group B's rate?

- A.** 10.5%
- B.** 8%
- C.** 18%
- D.** 12%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A health system gives each of its clinics the same \$50,000 outreach budget. Clinic A serves a suburb with high insurance coverage; Clinic B serves a neighborhood where 40% of residents lack a car and many are uninsured. ~~The system's new logo appears on all outreach materials.~~ A board member calls the plan fair. Which statement best describes it?

Target word: equal vs. equitable **Decides:** Same budget despite very different needs.

A	Confusion set	That describes equality, not equity.
B	Correct	Equity matches resources to barriers; identical budgets ignore Clinic B's greater need.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the logic; equity directs more to higher need.
D	Absolute language	Equity aims to remove unfair barriers; it does not guarantee identical results on a deadline.

2. Answer D Concept 1 · transfer

Which action is an example of equity rather than equality?

Target word: pick the equity action — reverse direction **Decides:** Resources tailored to a group's barrier.

A	Inverted operation	Identical treatment for all is equality.
B	Confusion set	Same treatment for all; it may even miss those without email.
C	Absolute language	No policy can guarantee identical outcomes; equity addresses unfair barriers.
D	Correct	Targets a specific barrier for the group that faces it.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A hospital ~~with a top-rated cardiac unit~~ sees high heart-failure readmissions among patients from one ZIP code. Chart review shows many lack refrigeration for their medications and live far from grocery stores. ~~The hospital's cardiologists trained at leading programs.~~ Which step best addresses the root cause?

Target word: root-cause lever **Decides:** The barriers are refrigeration and food access at home.

A	Adjacent category	Adds clinical capacity but leaves the home conditions unchanged.
B	Camouflage	Clinical skill is already strong; it does not fix the refrigerator.
C	Confusion set	Treats a structural barrier as individual behavior.
D	Correct	Addresses the social determinants driving the readmissions.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A Spanish-speaking patient arrives for a consent discussion before surgery. Her bilingual adult son, ~~who works as a paralegal~~, offers to interpret. The clinic has phone access to qualified medical interpreters. ~~The clinic was recently named a best place to work~~. What should staff do?

Target word: who interprets consent **Decides:** Qualified interpreters are available and this is informed consent.

A	Correct	Consent needs accurate, neutral interpretation; family interpreters risk errors and filtering.
B	Dropped element	Drops the language-access requirement for meaningful consent.
C	Confusion set	Being bilingual is not the same as being a trained medical interpreter.
D	Camouflage	His job does not make him a neutral, qualified medical interpreter.

5. Answer A Concept 4

An administrator hears at a conference that AI scribes will cut physician documentation time in half. ~~The vendor's booth was the largest at the event~~, and three nearby systems have signed contracts. What is the best next step?

Target word: how to evaluate a trend **Decides:** Claims are unproven for this organization.

A	Correct	Evidence from a controlled trial of fit and results should precede a system-wide decision.
B	Camouflage	Peer adoption and marketing reach do not show the tool works here.
C	Absolute language	Blanket rejection is as unevidenced as blanket adoption.
D	Inverted operation	Waiting for universal adoption gives up any chance to test and learn early.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A health system moves most follow-up visits to video to cut no-shows. Afterward, follow-up completion rises overall but falls among patients over 75 and rural patients with poor broadband. ~~The telehealth platform won a design award~~. What is the best response?

Target word: response to a subgroup gap **Decides:** The drop is concentrated in groups with less access.

A	Correct	Preserves the gain while closing the access gap the change created.
B	Absolute language	Throws away a gain for most patients instead of fixing access.
C	Adjacent category	Design is not the barrier; broadband and device access are.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the subgroups whose care got worse.

7. Answer B Concept 6

Under a new contract, a primary care group receives a fixed monthly payment per enrolled member and shares in savings if total cost of care falls while quality targets are met. ~~The group's building recently added solar panels~~. Which behavior does this model reward most?

Target word: incentive of the payment model **Decides:** Fixed per-member pay plus shared savings tied to quality.

A	Absolute language	Quality targets would suffer and forfeit the savings.
B	Correct	Lower total cost with quality met earns the shared savings.
C	Inverted operation	That is the fee-for-service incentive; here extra volume adds cost, not revenue.
D	Adjacent category	Documentation matters, but the payment is not driven by per-visit billing.

8. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Which payment model gives a provider the most revenue for performing more tests and procedures, whether or not outcomes improve?

Target word: name the volume-based model **Decides:** Payment per service delivered.

A	Confusion set	Rewards meeting quality measures, not volume.
B	Inverted operation	A fixed per-member payment makes extra services a cost.
C	Correct	Each service billed is paid, so volume drives revenue.
D	Adjacent category	One price for an episode; extra services inside it are not paid separately.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A retail pharmacy chain opens walk-in clinics staffed by nurse practitioners that treat simple conditions like strep throat at a low posted price. ~~The chain's stores run loyalty programs with millions of members.~~ Hospitals dismissed the clinics as too basic. According to disruptive innovation theory, what makes this model disruptive?

Target word: why it is disruptive **Decides:** Simpler, cheaper, more convenient care for low-end needs that incumbents ignore.

A	Inverted operation	Disruptors start at the low end, not the top.
B	Confusion set	Disruption is about business model and access, not higher technology.
C	Camouflage	Customer reach helps, but it is not what defines disruption.
D	Correct	That is the disruptive pattern incumbents tend to dismiss.

10. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A hospital adds a robotic system that makes its complex surgeries somewhat more precise for its existing, well-insured patients. What type of innovation is this?

Target word: classify the innovation — reverse case **Decides:** Better performance for existing best customers.

A	Adjacent category	It changes clinical care, not billing processes.
B	Absolute language	Newness alone does not make an innovation disruptive.
C	Correct	Improves an existing high-end offering for current customers.
D	Inverted operation	It is costlier and aimed at the top of the market, not the low end.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A health system stratifies its maternal outcomes. Among 2,000 Black mothers, 36 had severe maternal morbidity; among 5,000 white mothers, 40 did. ~~The analysis was run in the system's new data warehouse.~~ What is the rate ratio for Black vs. white mothers?

Target word: rate ratio **Decides:** Rates are 1.8% and 0.8%.

A	Adjacent category	That is the rate difference, not the ratio.
B	Dropped element	Compares raw counts (36 / 40) and drops the population sizes.
C	Correct	$36/2,000 = 1.8\%$; $40/5,000 = 0.8\%$; $1.8 / 0.8 = 2.25$.
D	Inverted operation	Divides the reference rate by the comparison rate.

12. Answer B Concept 8 · transfer

Group A's rate of missed cancer screenings is 12%. The rate ratio of Group A to Group B is 1.5. What is Group B's rate?

Target word: solve for the reference rate **Decides:** Group B rate = $12\% / 1.5$.

A	Adjacent category	Treats the ratio as a percentage-point difference.
B	Correct	$12\% / 1.5 = 8\%$.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies by the ratio instead of dividing.
D	Wrong stem number	Group A's rate, not Group B's.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Equality vs. equity	Equality gives everyone the same; equity sizes resources to need so people can reach similar outcomes.	Calling identical budgets fair by definition.	Groups with different starting needs receiving the same thing.
2	Social determinants of health	Conditions where people live, work and eat drive much of health; root-cause fixes address those conditions, not only clinical care.	Adding clinicians or blaming patient compliance for a social problem.	Outcomes cluster by ZIP code, income, food access, housing or transport.
3	Language access and cultural responsiveness	Use qualified medical interpreters for clinical communication, especially consent; family may support but should not interpret.	Letting a bilingual relative interpret because it is quick and trusted.	A limited-English patient, a key clinical conversation, and a willing relative.
4	Evaluating an emerging trend	Test a trend against evidence, fit and measurable results with a limited pilot before scaling.	Adopting because peers did (bandwagon) or rejecting all new technology.	Conference hype, vendor claims, or competitors signing on.
5	The digital divide	Technology that improves averages can widen gaps for groups with less access; check subgroups and keep alternatives.	Declaring success from an overall average.	An overall gain paired with a drop in older, rural or low-income groups.
6	Value-based vs. fee-for-service payment	Fee-for-service pays for volume; capitation and shared savings pay for keeping populations healthy at lower total cost while meeting quality targets.	Thinking every model rewards more visits.	Per-member payments, shared savings, or quality targets.
7	Disruptive vs. sustaining innovation	Disruptive innovation starts with simpler, cheaper, more convenient offerings for low-end or unserved needs and moves upmarket; sustaining innovation improves products for existing best customers.	Calling any new or high-tech product disruptive.	Simple, low-price service dismissed by incumbents vs. a premium upgrade.
8	Measuring disparities	Stratify data by group and compare rates (events / population); a rate ratio divides one group's rate by the reference group's rate.	Comparing raw counts, or confusing a rate difference with a rate ratio.	Event counts for groups of different sizes.

Course scope (public description): Exploring Emerging Trends in Healthcare Administration examines the impact of trends on healthcare administration, patient care, and industry transformation. With a focus on analyzing and synthesizing complex information related to healthcare, learners evaluate how advancements and innovations are transforming the healthcare industry and how to anticipate and adapt to trends as they appear. Introducing the practical implications of integrating Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) principles within the healthcare system, learners will explore: advocating for equitable healthcare practices, developing strategies to reduce health disparities, and promoting culturally sensitive and inclusive care for diverse populations. By understanding how to track and evaluate trends, learners will be prepared to navigate and contribute to the evolving landscape of

healthcare administration.